Complete Setup Guide

Every column · every transaction type · ticker format · year-end. For the 8 tabs, see your Template Link PDF.

TRANSACTION LOG: ALL COLUMNS

Col	Field	Notes
A	Date	Format yyyy-mm-dd. The transaction date.
B	Year	Calculated from column A. Do not edit.
C	Account	Dropdown: FHSA. Required on every row.
D	Type	Dropdown: Contribution · Buy · Sell · Dividend · DRIP
E	Ticker	Canadian: TSE: prefix required (TSE:XEQT). US: ticker only. Blank for contributions.
F	Description	Optional name or note.
G	Currency	CAD or USD. USD rows convert to CAD automatically.
H	Shares	Number of units for Buy, Sell and DRIP.
I	Price/Share	Price per unit in the original currency.
J	Fees	Brokerage fees, often $0.
K	Amount	Dollar amount for contributions and dividends. Blank for Buy and Sell.
L	FX Rate	Only for USD rows. Fetches the live USD/CAD rate.
M	Amt CAD	LOCKED: (H × I + J) or K, in CAD. Never edit.

TRANSACTION TYPES

Type	Required fields	Notes
Contribution	Date, Account, Type, Amount (K)	Counts against your annual room and the $40,000 lifetime limit.
Buy	Date, Account, Type, Ticker, Shares, Price	Buying ETF units inside the FHSA. Canadian: TSE: prefix.
Sell	Date, Account, Type, Ticker, Shares, Price	ACB recalculates. Gains inside the FHSA are never taxed.
Dividend	Date, Account, Type, Ticker, Amount	A cash distribution. Tax-free and never reported on your return.
DRIP	Date, Account, Type, Ticker, Shares, Price	A distribution reinvested in new units. Adds to your ACB.

GOOGLEFINANCE TICKER FORMAT: IMPORTANT

Canadian ETFs and stocks need the TSE: prefix in column E (TSE:XEQT). Without it, GOOGLEFINANCE can return the wrong price or $0. US stocks and ETFs use the ticker only, with no prefix.

Stock type	Correct format	Will cause problems	Real examples
Canadian ETFs & stocks (TSX)	Always add the TSE: prefix	XEQT or VFV alone can return $0	TSE:XEQT · TSE:VFV · TSE:XBAL · TSE:RY
US stocks (NYSE / NASDAQ)	Ticker only, no prefix	NASDAQ:AAPL can return $0	AAPL · MSFT · KO
US ETFs	Ticker only, no prefix	NYSE:SPY can fail	SPY · VTI · QQQ

The Canada-US tax treaty exemption covers RRSPs, not FHSAs. US dividends paid into an FHSA lose 15% to US withholding, and TSX-listed ETFs that hold US stocks (TSE:VFV) lose it inside the fund.

YEAR-END CHECKLIST

Item	What to do
Contributions	Make sure this year’s total is within $8,000 plus your carry-forward (at most $16,000). December 31 is the deadline.
Tax slips	Your FHSA provider sends a T4FHSA slip in February or March.
Schedule 15	File Schedule 15 with your return every year from the year you open the FHSA, even with no activity.
Line 20805	Claim the deduction, or carry it forward to a higher-income year.
Lifetime limit	Check total contributions stay within $40,000.
Investments	Shift from growth to balanced or bonds as your purchase gets within 2 to 5 years.
New year	Change the Active Year in Settings & Goals, update Unused Carry-Forward Room with what you didn’t use, and keep adding transactions below the existing rows.